

Eye exercises

Don't do this, or you'll go blind! No wait, we meant DO this or... just go to the link!
<http://bit.ly/aDeAw0>

Technology is killing you

We stumbled across a video of a Canadian program that asked the same questions we are...
<http://bit.ly/bEUH3r>

LIFESTYLE CHANGES

<http://bit.ly/dB4X>

The easiest thing to do is to lie to yourself. "I'll do it tomorrow", "I had a valid reason to not get any exercise today", and a million other things you can tell yourself to justify your sedentary lifestyle. However, your body doesn't hear these excuses, and doesn't care.

Let's look at a few everyday objects we use, and how they're killing us.

Automobiles

This one's a no-brainer. You don't get exercise, you use up fuel,



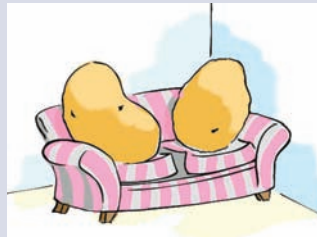
damage the environment and apart from costing you money for fuel, it's killing your body. Walking short distances and cycling longer ones are options, but not many of us choose them.

Mobile phones

Even if you ignore all the cell phone radiation studies, over-usage of a cell phone is still killing you. With mail, chat and social networking becoming the norm, we almost never put our cell phones down. Apart from the emotional friction between family members, this also causes stress to stay at high levels because you're effectively relaxing less.

TVs

Thanks to the television, we're spending our evenings doing one of the least physical activities of all time – sitting, staring at the



idiot-box and munching on snacks. Can you say couch potato, or is that too much effort?

Google, mobiles, calc and other shortcuts

Quick, what's 13 times 32? If you pulled out a mobile phone, used a calculator or typed "calc" in your PC's run dialog box, somewhere a buzzer that counts brain-dead humans just buzzed once... specially for you. The mind needs to be exercised just like the body. That's why we've tried to stimulate your mind through games like our Crack

The Code series in the past, and will continue to do so. However, you need to do more in order to sharpen your mind's skills. Don't use a computer or calculator for everything, or at least make sure you only use it for really complex calculations.

PCs

The most major way computers hurt you is when you don't follow ergonomic rules. Those aching backs, painful joints and sore wrists are all thanks to improper postures, and not enough rests when working. All of you know this already, so why not do something about it?

Share your thoughts and innovative ways in which everyday technology is killing us, and perhaps we can come up with solutions together as a community. Log on to the Digit Forum to discuss this.

couldn't even imagine the pains we used to go through, standing in lines trying to pay bills before electronic payments were commonplace. I wonder how many hours, days or even years of my life had been wasted in queues...

Wake up and smell the silicon

There was no real trigger incident that I can remember, or any specific point in time that I can pin down, but slowly I started to realise that the instrument of my success was also going to be the weapon that destroyed me. I do remember laughing at an article in an old magazine that I used to subscribe to; it was by some fellow with a weird name talking about how technology was killing us all... seemed like science fiction back then. It was so long ago I can hardly remember a word of it now, but I wish I'd paid more attention to it back then.

Anyway, as a self-proclaimed geek, I was always willing to try new technologies, and was almost always an early adopter. I was always finding new ways to do the same old

IS GOOGLE MAKING US STUPID?

<http://bit.ly/cXNeCU>

An interesting article from 2008. The author looks at how our surfing habits have changed to try and absorb a lot more, but not really understand it all. Worth a read.

things faster, and quicker. However, I paid the price for my geekdom. At first it was minor health problems. I noticed that I was sleeping a lot less; but then so was everyone else. I was also working longer hours, again, like everyone else... There was nothing out of the ordinary at the time about my life, except the nagging aches and pains and digestion problems that everyone around me had. Low immunity is what the quacks pointed at, and so I just ate a fruit or two to solve that problem – an apple a day, and all that. This worked well – long enough for me and others like me to forget all about the warning signs.

Some of my aches and pains were attributed to repetitive strain injuries (RSIs), but it's not like I could stop sending out emails from my PC and phone, or stop taking calls. So some pain killers and a few exercises minimised the discomfort. I had even stopped trying to group tasks together, in an attempt to kick my vicious multi-tasking addiction. I was only partly successful.

Of course, hindsight is always 20/20, so I am able to point out what was wrong with me back then, and possibly how I could have fixed it, but I suppose it's a little too late for any radical changes now. If only I could somehow contact someone from the past, and warn them. My message wouldn't even have to time travel much, perhaps just a decade or two back in time to around 2010... but what should such a message say?

Radiation

Although there are still conflicting studies about wireless technologies, with some proving that they're harmless and others proving the opposite, common sense should have told us to minimise the amount of radiation our brains were subjected to – just in case. Everything is wireless now, including electric power, and we have our gadgets implanted in our heads. Already some weird new cancer cases have begun to spring up. Is this the beginning of the end?

If only we'd have listened to the bees...

Exercise

I remember this movie called WALL·E that was popular back then. It took a dig at how dependant we were all becoming on tech-

ARE WE GETTING WEAKER?

<http://bit.ly/aZsJXm>

Another interesting article that asks the question, "Has modern living made the people weak, unhealthy and disease prone?" Read and decide for yourselves.